

Gareth Southern

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PROFILE

An experienced IT support and service delivery professional. A first career in customer-facing banking, then a deliberate restart into technology — apprentice to IT support officer to acting team leader. Skilled in incident and service request management, Microsoft 365 administration, ITSM tooling and service desk operations, with a strong record of improving processes and delivering clear, user-focused support. Outside work I run a self-hosted homelab (Linux, Docker, networking, automation), because the fastest way I learn is by running things myself and fixing what breaks.

EXPERIENCE

Acting Team Leader — IT Service Delivery

Sep 2025 – present

Social housing provider, North West England

- Day-to-day leadership support for the IT service desk: coordinating workloads, priorities and deadlines; escalation point for complex issues.
- Helped introduce more structured ticket-handling processes, improving consistency, visibility and service delivery performance.
- Work with internal stakeholders and external suppliers to maintain effective service delivery.
- Monitor service desk performance and trends to support continuous improvement.

IT Support Officer — Service Delivery

Dec 2019 – present

Social housing provider, North West England

- Day-to-day service desk support across tickets, email and in person; incident, request and escalation management with clear user communication.
- Microsoft 365 administration: user access, Teams, SharePoint and OneDrive.
- Supported service improvement initiatives, including the transition between ITSM platforms and ongoing process refinement.
- Onboarding of new starters: devices, accounts and system access; device deployment and asset tracking.
- Clear, user-friendly communications for system changes, updates and rollouts.

IT Infrastructure Technician Apprentice

Feb 2018 – Dec 2019

Social housing provider, North West England

- Completed the NVQ Level 3 Infrastructure Technician apprenticeship; CompTIA A+ and Microsoft Mobile Management along the way.
- Hands-on support for systems, users and devices in a live environment.

Customer Service & Operations Officer

Feb 2004 – Jun 2017

High-street bank

- Thirteen years of high-quality customer service in a fast-paced, regulated environment.
- Maintained compliance with data protection, AML and banking regulations.

CORE SKILLS

- IT service desk operations
- Incident & request management
- Microsoft 365 administration
- ITSM tools — Halo ITSM, Freshdesk, Remedy
- Service improvement & change support
- Team coordination & leadership
- Supplier coordination
- Onboarding & device management
- Data protection & information security
- Self-hosting, Docker & Linux
- Applied AI — LLM tooling, agent workflows & automation

EDUCATION & QUALIFICATIONS

- NVQ Level 3 — Infrastructure Technician (2019)
- CompTIA A+ (via apprenticeship)
- Microsoft Mobile Management (via apprenticeship)
- Certificate in Retail Banking — Level 3
- Certificate in Financial Services — Level 3
- Full UK driving licence

Employer names, references and further detail available on request. Projects and occasional writing: gazaka.com